

SUMMARY

- 1971 - Intel unveils first microprocessor, the 8080.
- 1974 - March. First ad for microprocessor-based personal computer kit, the Scelbi-8H. QST Magazine
 - First PC magazine, Creative Computing, published.
- 1975 - January. Popular Electronics cover story on MITS Altair 8800, "World's First Minicomputer Kit to Rival Commercial Models."
 - Microsoft BASIC introduced on the Altair. Would become the standard BASIC language for PCs.
- 1977 - Introduction of first assembled, ready-to-use personal computers, Radio Shack TRS-80, Apple II, Commodore PET.
 - (Radio Shack introduction - TRS-80 Model I, {August 3})
 - First Computerland franchise stores opened. (24 opened by year end.)
- 1978 - February. TIME Magazine special, "The Computer Society."
 - February. Radio Shack invites the public for hands-on computer demonstrations in Phoenix, AZ... the first of over 100 cities visited during the year. Thousands would have their first chance to see and try a PC.
 - July. Radio Shack opens first Radio Shack Computer Center. First company-owned (non-franchise) computer specialty chain. 50 open by end of year.
- 1979 - VisiCalc introduced. First software package to justify computer purchase.
 - Texas Instruments announces 99/4 computer.

- MicroPro announces WordStar word processing program.
- (Radio Shack introduction - TRS-80 Model II.)
- 1980 - September. Sinclair ZX-80 (later Timex/Sinclair) introduced. First computer under \$200.
- Apple announces the Apple III.
- Microsoft agrees to work with IBM on their PC-DOS operating system.
- Xerox, DEC, and Intel introduce Ethernet local area network.
- (Radio Shack introductions - TRS-80 Model III, Color Computer)
- 1981 - IBM announces the IBM Personal Computer, "legitimizing" the PC industry.
- Osborne introduces industry's first "transportable" computer.
- Commodore announces the VIC 20.
- 1982 - Commodore C64 announced.
- 1982-1983 brought great price wars in the low-end home computer market. TI's 99/4 started at \$1,200, closed out for about \$50. Commodore's VIC 20 and C64 dropped to \$199 and \$499 respectively. The Timex/Sinclair was cut to \$49. Many manufacturers abandon the PC market.
- October. Lotus 1-2-3 introduced. Ships in January 1983.
- November. Compaq portable announced. Ships in 1983.
- Radio Shack education division initiates a program to provide free computer literacy training for teachers.

Over 400,000 teachers would participate in the program during the next 4 years.

- (Radio Shack introductions - ARCNET, TRS-80 Model 16)

1983 - IBM introduces PCjr and PC-XT.

- January. TIME Magazine names the pc "Machine of the Year."
- January. Apple announces Lisa, with its Xerox Star-like, user-friendly interface. Interface succeeds, computer doesn't.
- March 31. First successful laptop computer, Radio Shack's Model 100.
- June. Coleco introduces Adam, complete system with printer for \$600. Plagued by reliability problems, it eventually fails.
- June. TI announces largest loss in corporate history. Withdraws from personal computer market.
- Mattel introduced the Aquarius, fails, withdraws from the market within a year.
- (Radio Shack introductions - TRS-80 Models 4, 4P, 12, 100, MC-10, Color Computer 2, and Tandy 2000)

1984 - Jack Tramiel buys Atari.

- IBM announces PC/AT.
- April. Apple announces Macintosh, Apple IIc.
- November 8. Tandy 1000 introduced. Within its first year, it becomes the number one selling PC compatible.

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- (Radio Shack introductions - Tandy Models 200, 1000, 1200HD, 6000)
- 1985 - June. Tandy 1000 becomes first PC compatible computer to sell for less than \$1,000.
- Leading Edge becomes first imported "PC clone" to achieve U.S. distribution.
 - (Radio Shack introductions - Tandy Models 4D, 600, 1200FD, 3000, Portable Disk Drive)
- 1986 - July. Gartner Group report says Tandy will take over from IBM as the PC of choice with businesses grossing less than \$500,000 annually.
- "PC Clones" from the Far East begin to gain acceptance and distribution in U.S. market.
 - PC store surveys by InfoCorp and Storeboard say Tandy exceeded combined sales of Apple and IBM during fourth quarter.
 - InfoCorp names Tandy number one in PC industry for 1986, "in a dead heat with Apple."
 - Compaq is first major vendor to introduce 80386-based computer.
 - (Radio Shack introductions - Tandy Models 102, 1000 EX, 1000 SX, 3000/35, 3000/40, 3000 HL, Color Computer 3)

1987 - April 2. IBM announced PS/2, concentrating on large DP customer needs, virtually abandoning low-end market. Products included models 30, 50, 60, 80, with Model 30 being the "low-end" offering, and not disk or expansion compatible with the 50, 60, or 80 series. All use 3.5" disks and analog monitors, incompatible with previous IBM models. 50-80 series use new "Microchannel" 32-bit bus, incompatible with older series and new Model 30. Although software is still compatible, hardware compatibility is now a myth. New 32-bit OS-2 operating system from Microsoft will be available to all Microsoft OEMs too.

COMPARISONS

Major industry companies		1977	1987
		Tandy Apple Commodore MITS Godbout Southwest Technical Products Processor Technology IMSAI	Tandy Apple Commodore IBM Compaq Epson AT&T Kaypro Leading Edge
Cost per Kb of RAM (\$66 in 1975	:	\$18.75	\$.38
Cost per Kb of disk storage	:	7.80 (89K FD)	.05 (20Mb HD)
Typical dot-matrix printer	Weight:	45 pounds	9 pounds
	Speed :	60 cps	100 cps
	Print Quality :	Acceptable	Much better
	Cost :	\$ 1,500	\$ 200
Low cost daisy-wheel printer	:	\$ 4,000	\$ 400
Latest microprocessor	:	Z-80	80386
type	:	8-bit	32-bit
maximum memory (bytes)	:	64,000	1,200,000,000
Most widely-used bus standard	:	S-100	IBM PC